

The Connections Sheet

Pick the right one, set it up, and do not leak a token doing it.

THE CHOOSING QUESTION

- **Finish this sentence honestly.** I keep switching windows to ____
- Whatever that is, connect that. Not the one that sounds most powerful.
- **If you cannot finish it, connect nothing today.** That is a real answer, not a failure, and it is the right one more often than people expect.

SO THEN

IF YOU KEEP SWITCHING TO	CONNECT
Your issue tracker, to see what is assigned	That tracker
A database, for the same read query	That database
Your docs, for a decision from months ago	That doc tool
Nothing. You are curious.	Nothing. Come back when you have an X.

LET IT DO THE SETUP RESEARCH

Setup differs per service, and it can read the current instructions

I want to connect [service] so I can [the thing you keep switching windows for].

Tell me: whether an official connector exists, exactly what I need including any credential, the command to add it, and what it will not be able to do.

If there is no good option, tell me that instead of improvising.

EVERY CONNECTION HAS A STANDING COST

What a connection can do is loaded into every session, whether you use it or not. Connect five things you do not need and you pay for all five on every message. This is the part everybody skips.

KEEPING THE CREDENTIAL OUT OF FILES

- A connection usually needs a token. A token belongs in an environment variable, never typed into a settings file.
- **If a setup guide tells you to paste a key straight into a file, stop and find the environment variable version.** Settings files get committed and shared, and this is the most common way a token escapes.

THE RULE, AND THE CHECK

- **One connection at a time.** Use it for a week. Only then consider a second.
- Use it for the real job immediately, not a test. If it does not save you the window switch, disconnect it the same day.
- Then run `/context` and find it in the list. Now you know its price, and whether the job was worth it.